

How Nature Shapes the Australian Character

Explore wildlife, landscapes, danger, humor, and national identity.

Which animal is more dangerous?

Look at the kangaroo and the snake.

Kangaroo

What do you already know?

Snake

What makes an animal dangerous?

DISCUSS: WHAT DO YOU KNOW ABOUT DANGEROUS ANIMALS IN AUSTRALIA?



KANGAROO · LOOK CLOSELY



SNAKE · LOOK CLOSELY

Key vocabulary for the lesson

Use these words when you discuss wildlife, landscapes, and survival.

Word	Meaning
deadly	very dangerous and able to kill you
venomous	able to produce poison that can hurt or kill
outback	a remote, dry area of Australia
to respect	to show care and admiration
survival	continuing to live despite difficulties

What does the title suggest?

How can dangerous wildlife and a unique landscape influence the way people live, think, and joke?

Prediction

Make one prediction before watching.

Language goal

Use at least two vocabulary words.



VIEWING 1 · 0:00–3:00

Catch the general idea

Does Steve look scared or excited?

Why?

Watch for

His attitude

Notice

His body language

Listen to

The way he talks about danger

DISCUSS YOUR ANSWER WITH A PARTNER.

VIEWING 2 · 3:00–5:55

True, False, or Not Given?

Watch and decide. Be ready to explain your answer.

1. Australia has more venomous snakes than non-venomous ones.
2. Steve is afraid of the snake and wants to run away.
3. Australians learn to live safely with dangerous animals from a young age.
4. Steve catches the snake with his bare hands.
5. The government pays people to catch snakes.

TRUE **FALSE** **NOT GIVEN**

DISCUSSION

Danger, humor, and national identity

Study the “Top 5 Deadliest Animals in Australia” infographic. Discuss in groups:



Danger

Why might Australians joke about these dangers?



Humor

What makes the topic funny or surprising?



Identity

Does this attitude show fear, respect, pride, or all three?

5 THE TOP 5 DEADLIEST ANIMALS IN AUSTRALIA



SALTWATER CROCODILE



INLAND TAIPAN



BLUE-RINGED OCTOPUS



TEXTILE CONE SNAIL



GREAT WHITE SHARK

GROUP TASK

Create a Survival Guide

You are tour guides for foreign visitors in Australia.
Write four rules for staying safe and enjoying nature.

1. Rule: _____
2. Rule: _____
3. Rule: _____
4. Rule: _____

EXAMPLE: ALWAYS SWIM BETWEEN THE FLAGS.



DIALOGUE OF CULTURES

Compare Australia with your country



Lifestyle

How does nature shape people’s lifestyle?



Connection

Are people as connected to the outdoors as Australians?



Character

Is there a specific national character? What is it like?

SHARE ONE SIMILARITY AND ONE DIFFERENCE.

EXIT TICKET

Why do you think Australians are proud of their dangerous nature?

Write one clear answer. Use at least one lesson word.

HOMEWORK

Write 50 words

Write about the most beautiful or dangerous nature in your country.

Explain why.